Checking Whether an Element Exists

To see if an element exists in the array, use the array_key_exists() function:

if (array_key_exists(key, array)) { ... }

The function returns a Boolean value that indicates whether the first argument is a valid key in the array given as the second argument.

It is not sufficient to simply say:

```
if ($person['name']) { ... }          // this can be misleading
```

Even if there is an element in the array with the key name, its corresponding **value** might be false (i.e., 0, NULL, or the empty string). Instead, use array_key_exists(), as follows:

```
$person['age'] = 0; // unborn?

if ($person['age']) {
  echo "true!\n";
}

if (array_key_exists('age', $person)) {
 echo "exists!\n";
}
```

```
exists!
```

Many people use the isset() function instead, which returns true if the element exists and is not NULL:

```
$a = array(0, NULL, '');

function tf($v)
{
    return $v ? 'T' : 'F';
}

for ($i=0; $i < 4; $i++) {
  printf("%d: %s %s\n", $i, tf(isset($a[$i])), tf(array_key_exists($i, $a)));
}
```

```
0: T T
1: F T
2: T T
3: F F
```

Removing and Inserting Elements in an Array

The array_splice() function can remove or insert elements in an array and optionally create another array from the removed elements:

$removed = array_splice(array, start [, length [, replacement]]);

We will look at array_splice() using this array:

Keyword

Value is the representation of some entity that can be manipulated by a program.